

## The Army of Usamah:

1. The first time the Muslims encountered the Arabs of Ghassanids was in the 7<sup>th</sup> year of hijrah in the **Battle of Mu'tah** during the lifetime of the Prophet ﷺ and then he went himself as well to that area in the 9<sup>th</sup> AH during the **Battle of Tabuk**. In the battle of Tabuk, no army came forward and so the Prophet ﷺ managed to sign **peace treaties** with the neighboring tribes.
2. Fearing a threat from the Romans, the Prophet ﷺ **decided to launch an offensive** before his fatal illness started and appointed Usamah bin Zaid, who was only 17-18 at that time, to lead the army. He **instructed them to march to al-Balqa and Palestine**.
3. The army departed from Madinah when the Prophet ﷺ was fatally ill and they **camped just outside Madinah at al-Jurf**.
4. When the news of the **death of the Prophet** ﷺ reached the army, they came back to Madinah and after the burial of the Prophet ﷺ, the very first challenge Abu Bakr had to face was the decision about the army of Usamah as some companions objected to two things:
  - a. They had the opinion that Madinah would be **unsafe** and many tribes would try to attack Madinah, wanting to take advantage of the death of the Prophet ﷺ, so it would not be wise to send Usamah's army at this stage.
  - b. They also objected to **Usamah being appointed as the leader** as he was too young and other senior companions were there in the army.
5. Abu Bakr initially held a meeting with the companions and listened to their concern but he didn't find their concerns legit and he responded:

**"By the One Who has the soul of Abu Bakr in His Hand, had I thought that wild predatory animals would make off with me, I would still send out Usamah's army in accordance with what the Messenger of Allah ﷺ commanded Usamah to do. And even if I were the last person to remain in these cities, I would still do the same."**

6. Still, after Abu Bakr's decision, some of the companions had their last shot in trying to convince Abu Bakr regarding Usamah. They **sent Umar ibn al-Khattab to convince him**. But no longer did Umar proposed the idea, Abu Bakr grabbed the beard of Umar and said:

**"May your mother be bereaved of you, O son of al-Khattab! It was the Messenger of Allah ﷺ who appointed him, and now you are ordering me to dismiss him."**

Umar was disappointed in what he did and he expressed his anger in front of other companions.

7. Abu Bakr went along with the army of Usamah to **bid them farewell**. Usamah was riding his horse, while Abu Bakr was walking alongside. Usamah said to him, **"O Khaleefah of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, by Allah, you will indeed ride or I will come down."** Abu Bakr responded, **"By Allah, you will not descend. And by Allah, I will not ride. For what harm will it do me to get my feet covered in dust as I walk in the way of Allah."**
8. Abu Bakr also gave **certain instructions** to the army, including:
  - a. Not to be treacherous.
  - b. Not to deceive.
  - c. Not to take wrongly from the war booty.

- d. Not to cut down a tree that bears fruits.
  - e. Not to slaughter an animal unless you want to feed yourself.
  - f. Not to harm the monks and leave them in their monasteries.
9. Heraclius got the news of the attack and the death of the Prophet ﷺ on the same day and he was surprised to know about the attack and he said, **"What is the matter with them? Their companion (ﷺ) dies and then they attack our land."**
10. This also had a great effect on the Arabs of those lands (near the Byzantine Empire) and said, **"If they were not powerful, they would not have sent this army."**

## **The Battles of Ridda/War against the apostates**

1. After the death of the Prophet ﷺ, Abu Bakr had to face **three categories** of people:
  - a. The apostates, who left Islam.
  - b. The false prophets and their followers.
  - c. Those who refused to pay the zakah.

## **Those who refused to pay Zakah**

2. As for the first two categories, there is no dispute that they are outside the folds of Islam. However, on the third category, there are two major opinions:
  - a. Abu Bakr fought them as he **thought them to be non-Muslims**, considering the payment of zakat to be from the fundamentals, without which one cannot be a Muslim.
  - b. Abu Bakr fought them because he **considered the payment of zakah to be essential for a Muslim to be safe from being fought**. In other words, he considered them to be Muslims but he fought them as he considered their act of not paying the zakah to be a grave sin and a sin worthy enough to be fought against.
3. Umar initially didn't agree with Abu Bakr regarding fighting those who refused to pay zakah and said, **"How can you fight against the people in spite of what the Prophet ﷺ said: 'I have been ordered to fight against the people until they say: لا إله إلا الله'. If anyone says that, then his wealth is protected from me, and so is his life, unless it is by some right and his accountability is with Allah."** Abu Bakr responded, **"By Allah, were they to refuse to give me a camel's headband, which they used to give to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, I would fight them for having refused to give it."** He also said, **"By Allah, I will fight against anyone who distinguishes between the prayer and zakah."**
4. Some of the **delegations came to Abu Bakr** to negotiate about zakah but Abu Bakr remained uncompromised on his stance.
5. Abu Bakr knew that Madinah would be susceptible to attack, therefore he did the following:
  - a. Ordered males to **spend the night in Masjid an-Nabawi** in case of a surprise attack so they can retaliate.
  - b. **Appointed guards** at various points in Madinah.
  - c. Requested **manpower from neighboring tribes**.
  - d. Sent letters to the Muslims living in the tribes of apostates to gather a **local army** and deal with the apostates.

6. Some fighters from the tribes of Asad, Ghatafan, Abs, Dhibyaan and Bakr gathered to attack Madinah and sent some fighters ahead to monitor the situation. The guards appointed at the outskirts of Madinah managed to send a report to Abu Bakr who came with a contingent and managed to force the attackers to retreat. And so the people got to know that Madinah was protected and they didn't dare to attack Madinah.
7. In order to deal with different uprisings, Abu Bakr sent armies towards each area.
8. Abu Bakr also sent letters across Arabia to call them back to Islam.

## Wars against False prophets

### Al-Aswad al-Ansee

1. His name was **Abhalah ibn Ka'b**. He was known as "aswad" because of his complexion.
2. He belonged to the sub-tribe of Mad'hij tribe, the Ans tribe in Yemen.
3. He claimed prophethood after the farewell hajj of the Prophet ﷺ and he gave himself the title "The merciful of Yemen".
4. After his claim, Banu Harithah from Najran (who were officially Muslims at this time) showed their support for him. Some other tribes also joined.
5. After 25 days of his claim of prophethood, he managed to conquer San'a.
6. The Prophet ﷺ got to know about it and asked Mua'dh bin Jabal to gather men against al-Aswad.
7. The people had two choices:
  - a. All-out war against the forces of al-Aswad.
  - b. Assassinating al-Aswad as their movement was not based on a strong ideology rather it was based on an individual only.
8. The Muslims managed to kill al-Aswad through the help of his wife whom he had married forcefully.
9. The news of the assassination of al-Aswad reached Madinah after the death of the Prophet ﷺ.

